

Selecting Your Next Wireless Router



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The ever-changing technology, bandwidth requirements and the fact that you want the device to work for at least the next few years are some factors that make choosing an appropriate wireless router quite difficult. You would want to spend on something that delivers great performance, along with adequate coverage, and offers long-term proposition. Highly technical specifications may increase the confusion even further. So, before finalising a wireless router for your home, go through this guide for buying (read: investing in) the device.

Why do you need a wireless router

A wireless router can connect a device to the Internet wirelessly and allow you to communicate with the world using a network at your home. But, do you really need a wireless router for this communication? If you are one of those people who work on one laptop, or PC, and do

not have other devices that need to be connected to the Internet, and you also do not like to change your position while working, then you can go for a DSL modem (you do not need a wireless router in that case). However, things are different these days. In this age of mobility, people use multiple devices, and hence a wireless router is a necessity. It allows you to go truly mobile, whether you want to access Facebook from your bedroom or chat with a friend on Whatsapp from your living room.

How do you use your network

When choosing a wireless router for your home, you have to check your requirements first. If you are a basic user, who only surfs the Internet and is looking for simple Wi-Fi connectivity, a single-band router is a good choice. But if you have to perform bandwidth-demanding tasks, like heavy-duty gaming or high-definition video streaming, you should opt for a high-end wireless router.

SOME WIRELESS ROUTERS FOR HOME

	iBall iB-WRB300N mIMO 300Mbps wireless N router	TP-Link 300Mbps wireless N router (TL-WR841N)	Netgear JNR1010-100PES 4PT BRIC N150 wireless router	D-LINK DIR-803 AC750 dual-band wireless router
				
Price	₹ 1299	₹ 1326	₹ 1890	₹ 2379
Features worth looking at	Wireless security such as WEP, WPA and WPA2-PSK encryption security; firewall security features such as access restriction (time and schedule based); parental control (IP, MAC and domain filtering), DoS, and remote and local management	Parental-control, auto-mail function and easy set-up assistant	Live parental control and Internet speed optimisation	750Mbps wireless speed, 4 LAN ports and IPv6 support

The prices mentioned here are from various e-commerce portals and are subject to change.